

JOY CRUSADERS: **(1)** YouTuber Ashish Chanchlani; **(2)** Arun Mishra, IAS, Secretary, Environment, Government of Goa; **(3)** Anant Goenka, **(6)** Aroon Purie, Chairman and Editor-in-Chief, India Today Group; **(7)** Shantanu Mishra, Co-founder, Smile Foundation; **(8, 9)** Megha Tata and Kumar, Founder, The Viral Fever; **(12)** *Bhediya* actor Abhishek Banerjee, **(13, 14, 15)** *Panchayat 2* actors Raghubir Yadav, Faisal Malik and

CHAMPIONS

The Happiness Fest and Awards celebrated the most inspiring, funny and positive influencers for bringing joy and giving hope to people in these trying times

By **SUHANI SINGH**

Music, laughter and a celebration of the most inspiring, funny and positive influencers—that's how the India Today Group and RPG Group brought down the curtains on their second season of the Happiness Quest campaign with the Happiness Fest and Awards at a gala evening in Mumbai on March 25.

It was in 2022 when the two came together to launch the Happiness Quest, a much-needed initiative after the Covid-19 pandemic had left people reeling from anxiety and grief. Under such trying circumstances, it seemed the best time for seeking answers to what truly makes one happy. In the face of adversity, how does one rise and find new meaning in life, to maintain equanimity and remain cheerful?

This year, as the quest entered its second season, it was pegged around three tentpoles. First, in January, the INDIA TODAY